

D842

# Technology and Ethics: A Look at Emerging Trends and Society

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

**What this is.** Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

**Source.** Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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# How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

|                             |                                           |                        |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>_____ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------|

# Items

1.

A home-care company with offices in four states is deciding whether to replace human check-in calls to elderly clients with an automated voice system. The system would save \$2 million a year. One manager argues that clients depend on the relationship and the caller's attention to subtle changes in their needs. Which framework does the manager's argument reflect?

- A. Utilitarianism, because savings matter most.
- B. Care ethics.
- C. Egoism.
- D. Deontology.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which argument about a school's AI tutor would a care ethicist most likely make?

- A. It should never be used by anyone.
- B. It should be used only if it follows a rule every school could adopt.
- C. It should support, not replace, teacher relationships, especially for students who need extra attention.
- D. It should be used if it raises average test scores the most.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

3.

A ride-share app with a sleek new logo is designing its pricing rules. The design team is asked to choose the rules without knowing whether they would be a wealthy rider, a low-income rider, or a driver. The company is based in a major city. What ethical method is being used?

- A. Rawls's veil of ignorance.
- B. Brand ethics based on the logo.
- C. Virtue ethics.
- D. Cost-benefit analysis.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**4.** [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Behind a veil of ignorance, which rule would people most likely choose for an app that sets prices by demand?

- A.** Cap price surges during emergencies so low-income riders can still get rides.
- B.** Allow unlimited surges to maximize company profit.
- C.** No rule, since fairness cannot be defined.
- D.** Let wealthy riders skip the line for free.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**5.**

A startup that has raised \$50 million wants to release a gene-editing kit for home use. Scientists say long-term effects are unknown and could be irreversible. The founder gave a popular TED-style talk. Under the precautionary principle, what should happen?

- A.** Ban all biotechnology research forever.
- B.** The company should show evidence of safety before wide release.
- C.** Release it, since no harm has been proven.
- D.** Release it because the founder is persuasive.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**6.** [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A new app has well-studied, minor, and reversible risks. Does the precautionary principle require delaying its release?

- A.** No, because apps are never harmful.
- B.** Yes, because it is new technology.
- C.** Yes; every risk requires delay.
- D.** No; the principle targets uncertain, serious, or irreversible harm.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

7.

A streaming service with 30 million subscribers makes the cancel button gray and small, hides it three menus deep, and asks, Are you sure you want to lose all your favorites? Its lawyers say the design is legal. Why is this ethically troubling?

- A. It is fine because it is legal.
- B. It violates copyright law.
- C. It is fine because users can still cancel eventually.
- D. It is a dark pattern that undermines user autonomy.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which design choice best respects user autonomy?

- A. Hiding the Decline option in fine print.
- B. Accept and Decline buttons that are equally visible, with plain wording.
- C. A pre-checked box for sharing data.
- D. A countdown timer pressuring users to decide.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

9.

A student who has 5,000 followers sees a realistic video of a local mayor saying something offensive. The source is an anonymous account created last week. The video already has 200,000 views. What is the most ethical action?

- A. Assume every video online is fake.
- B. Share it with a comment saying it might be fake.
- C. Share it, since many people already have.
- D. Verify the video with reliable sources before sharing.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**10.**

An automated loan system built by a team of 40 engineers wrongly denies loans to many qualified applicants. The data team blames the model, the engineers blame the data, and managers blame the vendor. The system uses advanced machine learning. What is the best ethical view?

- A.** Only the vendor is responsible.
- B.** No one is responsible because many people were involved.
- C.** Responsibility is shared, and the organization must assign accountability for fixing the harm.
- D.** The machine learning system is responsible.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**11.**

After a university with a large campus installs cameras and message monitoring, students stop posting lawful opinions on political topics. The system cost \$1 million. What does this illustrate?

- A.** A chilling effect.
- B.** Proof that surveillance only affects wrongdoers.
- C.** A waste of money.
- D.** The digital divide.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

**12.**

A teen posts a sarcastic joke meant for close friends on a public account with a colorful profile picture. A coach and a future employer see it and misread it. The post got 50 likes. What concept explains this?

- A.** Proof that posts reach only friends.
- B.** A filter bubble.
- C.** Context collapse.
- D.** Chilling effect.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

# STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

# Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

## 1. Answer B Concept 1

A home-care company ~~with offices in four states~~ is deciding whether to replace human check-in calls to elderly clients with an automated voice system. ~~The system would save \$2 million a year.~~ One manager argues that clients depend on the relationship and the caller's attention to subtle changes in their needs. Which framework does the manager's argument reflect?

**Target word:** identify the framework **Decides:** Focus on dependency, relationship, and responsiveness.

|          |                   |                                                                |
|----------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Camouflage        | The savings figure is not the manager's argument.              |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Centers relationships and responsiveness to vulnerable people. |
| C        | Confusion set     | Focuses on the agent's self-interest.                          |
| D        | Adjacent category | Focuses on universal duties or rules, not relationships.       |

## 2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

Which argument about a school's AI tutor would a care ethicist most likely make?

**Target word:** produce the care-ethics argument **Decides:** Attention to relationships and individual need.

|          |                   |                                                             |
|----------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Absolute language | Care ethics weighs context; it does not ban tools outright. |
| B        | Adjacent category | Kantian universalizability.                                 |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Protects relationships and responds to need.                |
| D        | Confusion set     | Utilitarian reasoning.                                      |

## 3. Answer A Concept 2

A ride-share app ~~with a sleek new logo~~ is designing its pricing rules. The design team is asked to choose the rules without knowing whether they would be a wealthy rider, a low-income rider, or a driver. ~~The company is based in a major city.~~ What ethical method is being used?

**Target word:** name the method **Decides:** Choosing rules without knowing one's position.

|          |                   |                                                |
|----------|-------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Fair rules chosen without knowing one's place. |
| B        | Camouflage        | Irrelevant.                                    |
| C        | Confusion set     | Focuses on character.                          |
| D        | Adjacent category | Adds up outcomes; does not hide positions.     |

## 4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

Behind a veil of ignorance, which rule would people most likely choose for an app that sets prices by demand?

**Target word:** apply the method to predict a choice **Decides:** Not knowing their position, people protect the worst-off.

|          |                    |                                                 |
|----------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Protects those who could be worst-off.          |
| B        | Inverted operation | Only appealing if you know you are the company. |
| C        | Absolute language  | The method exists to define it.                 |
| D        | Adjacent category  | Favors a known advantaged group.                |

## 5. Answer B Concept 3

A startup ~~that has raised \$50 million~~ wants to release a gene-editing kit for home use. Scientists say long-term effects are unknown and could be irreversible. ~~The founder gave a popular TED-style talk.~~ Under the precautionary principle, what should happen?

**Target word:** precautionary response **Decides:** Uncertain, potentially irreversible harm.

|          |                    |                                           |
|----------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| A        | Absolute language  | Precaution is not a total ban.            |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | The burden of proof shifts to proponents. |
| C        | Inverted operation | Treats uncertainty as safety.             |
| D        | Camouflage         | Popularity does not show safety.          |

## 6. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

A new app has well-studied, minor, and reversible risks. Does the precautionary principle require delaying its release?

**Target word:** when the principle does not apply **Decides:** Risks are known, minor, and reversible.

|          |                   |                                                       |
|----------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Absolute language | Right conclusion, but the reason is a false absolute. |
| B        | Dropped element   | Drops the severity and uncertainty conditions.        |
| C        | Absolute language | Overextends the principle.                            |
| <b>D</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Conditions for precaution are not met.                |

## 7. Answer D Concept 4

A streaming service ~~with 30 million subscribers~~ makes the cancel button gray and small, hides it three menus deep, and asks, Are you sure you want to lose all your favorites? Its lawyers say the design is legal. Why is this ethically troubling?

**Target word:** ethical problem **Decides:** Design pressures users against their choice.

|          |                   |                                                     |
|----------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Camouflage        | Legal is not the same as ethical.                   |
| B        | Adjacent category | Not a copyright issue.                              |
| C        | Dropped element   | Ignores the manipulation.                           |
| <b>D</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Manipulates users away from what they would choose. |

## 8. Answer B Concept 4 · transfer

Which design choice best respects user autonomy?

**Target word:** the non-manipulative design **Decides:** Clear, balanced choices.

|          |                    |                                       |
|----------|--------------------|---------------------------------------|
| A        | Adjacent category  | Obscures a choice.                    |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Honest, balanced choice.              |
| C        | Inverted operation | Defaults users into sharing.          |
| D        | Confusion set      | Artificial urgency is a dark pattern. |

## 9. Answer D Concept 5

A student ~~who has 5,000 followers~~ sees a realistic video of a local mayor saying something offensive. The source is an anonymous account created last week. ~~The video already has 200,000 views.~~ What is the most ethical action?

**Target word:** action before sharing **Decides:** Realistic media with unclear source.

|   |                   |                                          |
|---|-------------------|------------------------------------------|
| A | Absolute language | Blanket distrust also harms trust.       |
| B | Dropped element   | Still spreads possibly false content.    |
| C | Camouflage        | Popularity is not verification.          |
| D | <b>Correct</b>    | Duty to verify possible synthetic media. |

## 10. Answer C Concept 6

An automated loan system built by a team of 40 engineers wrongly denies loans to many qualified applicants. The data team blames the model, the engineers blame the data, and managers blame the vendor. ~~The system uses advanced machine learning.~~ What is the best ethical view?

**Target word:** responsibility for system harm **Decides:** Many hands; responsibility must be assigned.

|   |                    |                                            |
|---|--------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| A | Dropped element    | Ignores others' roles.                     |
| B | Inverted operation | The problem of many hands, not its answer. |
| C | <b>Correct</b>     | Many hands does not remove responsibility. |
| D | Camouflage         | Tools do not hold moral responsibility.    |

## 11. Answer A Concept 7

After a university ~~with a large campus~~ installs cameras and message monitoring, students stop posting lawful opinions on political topics. ~~The system cost \$1 million.~~ What does this illustrate?

**Target word:** name the effect **Decides:** Lawful behavior changes due to monitoring.

|   |                    |                                                 |
|---|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>     | Self-censorship from awareness of surveillance. |
| B | Inverted operation | Lawful speech was affected.                     |
| C | Camouflage         | The cost is not the ethical issue.              |
| D | Adjacent category  | That concerns unequal access.                   |

## 12. Answer C Concept 8

A teen posts a sarcastic joke meant for close friends on a public account ~~with a colorful profile picture.~~ A coach and a future employer see it and misread it. ~~The post got 50 likes.~~ What concept explains this?

**Target word:** name the concept **Decides:** Separate audiences merged.

|   |                    |                                                   |
|---|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| A | Inverted operation | The opposite happened.                            |
| B | Adjacent category  | That narrows content one sees.                    |
| C | <b>Correct</b>     | Audiences normally separate see the same message. |
| D | Confusion set      | That is self-censorship from surveillance.        |

## Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

|                       | Right                                                 | Wrong                                                                                 |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sure</b>           | Owned.                                                | <b>Concept inversion — top priority.</b> A wrong mental model; it survives rewording. |
| <b>Unsure / guess</b> | Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer. | Not learned yet.                                                                      |

## Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

| Trap               | What it does                                                 | In this drill | Your misses |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|
| Dropped element    | Leaves out a required term or step.                          | 4             |             |
| Wrong stem number  | A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.      | 0             |             |
| Adjacent category  | The right idea in the wrong bucket.                          | 8             |             |
| Inverted operation | Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower. | 6             |             |
| Absolute language  | Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.           | 6             |             |
| Confusion set      | Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.       | 5             |             |
| Camouflage         | Answers a stem fact that was never the question.             | 7             |             |

# Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

| # | Concept                                     | Rule                                                                                                                                                   | Trap                                                                                                      | Tell                                                                 |
|---|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Care ethics</b>                          | Care ethics judges actions by how well they attend to relationships and respond to the needs of those who are vulnerable or dependent.                 | Treating care ethics as maximizing total happiness or following fixed rules.                              | Reasoning centered on relationships, dependency, and responsiveness. |
| 2 | <b>Rawls's veil of ignorance</b>            | A fair rule is one people would choose without knowing their own position in society, which favors protecting the least advantaged.                    | Choosing rules from one's current position.                                                               | Designing a policy as if you did not know which user you would be.   |
| 3 | <b>The precautionary principle</b>          | When a new technology risks serious or irreversible harm and evidence is uncertain, the burden falls on proponents to show safety before wide release. | Reading precaution as a ban on all innovation, or reading uncertainty as proof of safety.                 | Uncertain but potentially severe harm from a new technology.         |
| 4 | <b>Dark patterns and autonomy</b>           | Interface designs that trick or pressure users into choices they would not otherwise make undermine autonomy, even when technically legal.             | Assuming consent is valid because the user clicked.                                                       | Hidden options, confusing wording, or pre-checked boxes.             |
| 5 | <b>Deepfakes and the duty to verify</b>     | Synthetic media can cause harm to people depicted and erode public trust, so sharers have a duty to verify before spreading content.                   | Believing sharing is harmless if you did not create the fake.                                             | Realistic media of a person with an unclear source.                  |
| 6 | <b>The problem of many hands</b>            | When harm comes from a system built by many people, responsibility is shared and must be assigned deliberately; it does not vanish.                    | Concluding that no one is responsible because many contributed or because the system acted automatically. | An automated system caused harm and every role points to another.    |
| 7 | <b>The chilling effect of surveillance</b>  | Knowing one may be watched leads people to self-censor lawful speech and behavior, harming freedom even without punishment.                            | Arguing that surveillance only affects people with something to hide.                                     | People change lawful behavior after learning they are monitored.     |
| 8 | <b>Context collapse and the online self</b> | Social media merges audiences that are normally separate, so a message meant for one group reaches others and affects identity and reputation.         | Assuming a post reaches only the intended audience.                                                       | A post for friends reaches an employer or family.                    |

**Course scope (public description):** D842 Technology and Ethics: A Look at Emerging Trends and Society explores the intersection of ethical thinking and technological innovations. A foundational introduction to ethical frameworks is applied to emerging trends in technology including artificial intelligence, social media, and other forms of digital media. This course examines the impact of technology on our understanding of self as well as the individual's role in interacting with others in a globalized society. Through careful analysis and application, students gain the ability to recognize ethical actions within the context of current and newly evolving technological landscapes. Through the application of ethical frameworks, students gain the ability to evaluate actions taken

within the context of current and newly evolving technological landscapes. This course has no prerequisites.